

Case Study: AI-Powered Client Onboarding Emailer

The Problem

Every time a prospect filled out an intake form, the follow-up was manual. Copy the name, write a personalized email, remember to follow up two days later if they didn't book - all of it depended on someone remembering to do it. Response times varied. Follow-ups got missed. The process didn't scale.

For service businesses (consultants, bookkeepers, agencies), this is a common leak: the lead arrives, but the response isn't fast enough or personal enough to convert.

The Solution

An n8n automation that runs the moment a form is submitted:

1. **Logs the lead** to a Google Sheet - no more scattered inboxes or manual spreadsheet updates
2. **Drafts and sends a personalized welcome email in under 30 seconds** - Claude reads the prospect's stated goal and writes an email that directly addresses it, in the founder's voice
3. **Follows up automatically at 48 hours** if the prospect hasn't booked a call - one gentle nudge, then stops

No templates. No mail merge. Each email is generated fresh based on what the prospect actually said.

Build Details

Tools: n8n (self-hosted) · Claude API (claude-sonnet-4-6) · Tally · Gmail API · Google Sheets

Build time: ~6 hours

Ongoing cost: ~\$0.02 - \$0.05 per lead (Claude API usage only)

Results

Metric	Before	After
Time to first response	Hours (manual)	Under 30 seconds
Follow-up consistency	Inconsistent	100% - never missed
Time spent per new lead	5 - 10 min	0 min
Emails that reference prospect's specific needs	Depends on writer	Every single one

Results based on live test scenario with simulated lead submissions across multiple industries.

Sample Output

Form input:

Name: Sarah Chen

Business: Chen & Associates Bookkeeping

Industry: Accounting

Goal: Automate my monthly client reporting so I stop spending Sundays on spreadsheets

Claude-generated welcome email (sent in ~20 seconds):

Hi Sarah,

Thanks for reaching out - automating your monthly reporting so you get your Sundays back is exactly the kind of problem I love solving.

For a bookkeeping practice like yours, we can set up a workflow that pulls your client data, generates a plain-English summary, and delivers it to each client automatically - no manual formatting, no Sunday scramble.

I'd love to walk you through what that looks like for your specific setup. You can grab a 20-minute slot here: <https://calendly.com/hantous93>

Looking forward to it,

Sammi Hantous

AI Automation Consultant

48-hour follow-up (sent automatically if no booking):

Hi Sarah,

Just wanted to follow up since we connected a couple of days ago - no worries if the timing hasn't been right.

When you're ready to explore what automating your monthly reporting could look like, I'd love to map it out with you.

Feel free to grab a time here: <https://calendly.com/hantous93>

Sammi Hantous

AI Automation Consultant

Who This Is Built For

Any service business that:

- Gets leads through a form

- Wants faster, more personal responses without more manual work

- Is losing deals to slow follow-up

Best fit: bookkeeping firms, consultants, agencies, coaches, financial advisors

Finance Operations Extension

For accounting and financial services clients, this system can be extended to:

- Send an engagement letter via PandaDoc for e-signature immediately after the welcome email

- Trigger a client portal invite (Karbon, Canopy, or similar)

- Log the lead directly to a CRM or practice management tool

This saves 45 - 90 minutes per new client onboarding - at 5 new clients per month, that's 4 - 7 hours recovered monthly.

Built by Sammi Hantous · AI Automation Consultant · [YOUR WEBSITE]